

Agentic Design Studio : Design agents that can earn trust

Participant assignment brief

Your assignment: Design agents that can earn trust

Design an agent whose workflow, tools, authority, guardrails and evidence can be explained and defended.

1. Assignment at a glance

Choose one operational scenario and design how an AI agent should operate across the complete workflow. The task is not to write persuasive prompt wording first. It is to make the architecture explicit: scope, workflow, tools, state, rules, authority, exceptions, guardrails, operating loop and evidence.

Required outcome

A coherent Master Prompt with exactly 11 sections, supported by a Design Record containing your stage answers, and Designer tables.

What you will practise

- Separating deterministic automation, bounded agent judgement and accountable human decisions.
- Defining tool permissions, authoritative sources and observable verification.
- Designing escalation, recovery and layered guardrails before deployment.
- Expressing success as testable criteria with evidence and failure conditions.

How to work

1. Login to the website <https://oxford.summit2026.aparchai.ai/>. It uses ChatGPT account to authenticate.
2. Choose one scenario and keep it consistent across all 11 stages.
3. Answer the three essential questions in each stage in your own words.
4. Complete at least one meaningful row in each stage Designer table.
5. Review for completeness for both happy failure paths.
6. Assemble, inspect and review the final Master Prompt before submitting.

2. Choose one scenario

Code	Scenario	Operating context	Design focus
A	Employee IT Support	8,000 employees · 700 requests/day	Identity, device, access and technical requests within clear security boundaries.
B	Supplier Onboarding	Hundreds of suppliers each year	Verification, evidence, risk, compliance, approvals and vendor records.
C	Travel Disruption Resolution	Dynamic, time-sensitive conditions	Delays, cancellations and missed connections while options keep changing.
D	Invoice Exception Handling	Thousands of supplier invoices	Matching exceptions, payment risk and finance controls.

If using Custom Project, you may instead define a scenario using: scenario name; organisation and context; current problem; users and stakeholders; existing process; known systems and information; known constraints; and desired business outcome.

Scenario discipline

- Stay with the same scenario throughout the assignment.
- Use enough operational detail to make choices testable.
- If a fact, tool, permission or policy is not defined, label it as missing—do not invent it.
- Treat the worked example as a separate learning aid, not as your participant scenario.

3. The 11-stage design method

Stage	Design focus	Prompt section produced	Why it matters
01	Understand Scenario	Agent Role, Goal and Operating Context	Establish a bounded purpose before deciding how the agent should act.
02	Map Existing Workflow	Current Operating Environment and Process	Make the current work, hand-offs and completion evidence visible.
03	Redesign Workflow	Role Within the End-to-End Workflow	Separate deterministic automation, agentic judgement and accountable human work.
04	Define Tools	Available Information, Tools and Tool-use Rules	Specify what the agent may observe or change and how consequential actions are verified.
05	Design Memory & State	State and Memory	Keep persistent system state distinct from temporary reasoning context.
06	Design Decision Rules	Decision and Operating Rules	Translate policy, evidence and authority into explicit operating rules.
07	Design Exceptions	Exceptions, Failure Handling and Recovery	Design safe recovery before failures occur.
08	Human–AI Collaboration	Human Authority, Approval and Escalation	Make accountable authority and escalation decisions unambiguous.
09	Guardrails	Guardrails, Permissions and Prohibited Actions	Use layered controls so prompt wording is not the only safety mechanism.
10	Build Prototype	Execution and Operating Loop	Turn the design into a repeatable observe–plan–act–verify loop.
11	Evaluate Agent	Success Criteria, Evidence and Evaluation	Define observable success and failure before claiming the agent works.

Completion rule

A stage is complete when all three essential questions have substantive answers and its Designer contains at least one meaningful row. Optional questions deepen the design but do not replace the essentials.

4. Working in the Site

Open the Site(<https://oxford.summit2026.aparchai.ai/>) and sign in to chatgpt and agree to privacy notice. The Home page shows your projects and their status.

1. Open Learning Guide for a professional tour of the workflow and controls.
2. Review the worked example to see the expected quality without copying its scenario.
3. Create a project and choose one scenario.
4. Use Continue to reopen the last saved stage. The stage rail shows all 11 stages and highlights the current stage.
5. Record decisions in the questions and Designer table. Use Back to home or Exit whenever you need to leave the project.
6. After all 11 stages are complete, open the Master Prompt area and perform the controlled ChatGPT handoff.
7. Paste the final Master Prompt back into the Site, review the Design Record PDF and submit.

5. Controlled Master Prompt handoff

- The Site packages the project name, selected scenario, answers and Designer rows from all 11 stages. Click Copy and open ChatGPT.

Return and review

1. Review ChatGPT's output against your recorded design.
2. Correct invented assumptions, vague authority and unsupported claims.
3. Paste the complete Master Prompt into the editable final-prompt field.
4. Make any final edits. Saving retains a new version.

6. What strong work looks like

Quality	Evidence in your work
Specificity	Named systems, roles, boundaries and evidence; no generic filler.
Bounded authority	Explicit autonomous, approval-required, human-only and prohibited actions.
Observable operation	Tool results and authoritative state prove outcomes.
Recoverability	Failures trigger safe retry, re-plan, escalation or stop.
Controlled decisions	Deterministic rules remain deterministic; human consequential decisions remain accountable.
Testability	Every criterion includes evidence and a failure condition.
Internal consistency	Workflow, tools, memory, rules and guardrails agree with one another.

7. Submission requirements

Submit only when all 11 stages are complete and the final Master Prompt is present.

Deliverable	Must contain
Master Prompt	One coherent operating prompt with exactly 11 required sections.

Deliverable	Must contain
Design Record PDF	Latest answers, Designer outputs, change history and final Master Prompt.

Final checklist

- ☐ One scenario is used consistently.
- ☐ All 33 essential questions have substantive answers.
- ☐ Every Designer table has at least one meaningful row.
- ☐ Human authority and prohibited actions are explicit.
- ☐ Exceptions include safe recovery and stop conditions.
- ☐ At least five success criteria include evidence and failure conditions.
- ☐ The final prompt has been reviewed for invention and contradiction.
- ☐ The Design Record PDF has been previewed.
- ☐ The project has been submitted.

8. Practical controls and fallback

Control	Participant behaviour
Continue	Reopens the last saved stage without restarting the project.
Back to home / Exit	Returns to Projects without losing saved progress.
Cancel project	Marks the project cancelled; the organiser can see the cancelled status.
Versions	Prompt edits and submissions create retained snapshots for review.
Privacy	Participant work is private to the account and visible to authorised organisers.
Offline fallback	Use the Complete Offline Workbook; it mirrors all stages, questions and tables.

Work safely

Use realistic but non-sensitive data. If the Site becomes unavailable, continue in the offline workbook. Keep the same project name and scenario so the work can later be transferred or reviewed consistently.